WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS

Five of the warmest years ever measured. A cyclone that killed 138,000 people in 1991 and a cyclone that killed dozens in 2020, on the same coastline. A heatwave that killed 70,000 Europeans in 2003 and a hotter one that killed 61,700 in 2022 because the institutions had changed.

This book reads the record of the past two decades closely enough to show why the next disaster will fall on some places and not others, and it argues that the difference is usually a decision rather than a fate.

Twenty-four chapters, twenty-five data tables, eleven data figures, twenty-four case studies and a reference list of 145 sources. Written for readers who want the evidence rather than the slogan.

- Why a cyclone killed 500,000 people in 1970 and dozens in 2020 on the same coastline
- The heatwave that killed 70,000 Europeans in 2003 — and the hotter one that killed 61,700 in 2022
- The Ahr valley, where the forecast was right and 180 people died anyway
- What a heat action plan, a shelter register and a protected budget line actually cost
- The four clocks of climate policy: emissions, concentration, temperature, sea level
- How to read a death toll, a loss estimate and a warning that never reached its street

A prepared world is not a world without disasters. It is a world in which the same event kills fewer people.

Setyo Wisodo writes about disaster risk, climate adaptation and community resilience. This book distils two decades of disaster records into a single argument about what allows a place to survive a crisis and what does not.

Crisis, Climate, and Human Resilience

SURVIVING THE FUTURE

SETYO WISODO

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THE DEFINITIVE GUIDE TO THE CENTURY OF CRISES

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Survival is a decision, not a fate.